

Brainstorming: Rhetorical Situations Assignment

Brainstorm:

I have chosen season 4 episode 11 of *Star Trek: The Next Generation*, “Data’s Day.”

Here are several links to watch the episode yourself:

[Pluto TV](#)

[Paramount Plus](#)

[YouTube](#)

Summary:

As the episode is from a science-fiction adventure TV series, its primary purpose is to entertain. But there are a couple of other things that the episode does. It has two main storylines: Data has been asked to give away the bride for the wedding of his friends Keiko Ishikawa and transporter chief Miles O’Brien, and the Enterprise must escort a Vulcan ambassador into the Romulan neutral zone to conduct treaty negotiations. These are the set up and continuation of important storylines and character arcs for later in the series, and even into other Star Trek series, as in the case of Keiko and Miles O’Brien. The Romulan arc later climaxes in the season four finale, and season five opener: the two-part “Redemption.”

Now for the audience, this is one of the more humorous episodes of *The Next Generation*. It explores Data’s general incompetence with navigating social situations, and willingness to explore more aspects of human society and culture. Things like dancing and weddings. It is one of the easiest ways to introduce someone to *Star Trek*, because of its forementioned humor, and its relatable plot beats. It’s not closer to fantasy, with crazy science fiction elements, it’s more of a political thriller/mystery and a lighthearted slice of life episode.

Questions:

Rhetors: The episode was directed by Robert Wiemer and was written by Harold Apter along with a teleplay by Ronald D. Moore. The episode is wonderfully made. It’s got good

pacing; there's not a boring moment. It manages to balance its two storylines well, Data trying to navigate Keiko and O'Brien's wedding is heartfelt and funny, and the Vulcan ambassador's storyline adds needed tension. The acting by Brent Spiner, who plays Data, is excellent. Even though Data doesn't show any emotion, he manages to be funny throughout with excellent physical acting and deadpan delivery of the characters' lines. Data, along with the whole episode, is full of heart and is a treat to watch every time.

Constraints: As this episode needs to fit into a 45-minute time slot and must tackle multiple plots, it can't flesh them out as much as feature length movie could. There are a couple of other limitations to it being a syndicated tv series. The episode, along with the whole show, doesn't have the highest production values (though much less pronounced than its predecessor), and it was originally broadcast in standard resolution with a 4:3 aspect ratio. It's not comparable in the looks department to a modern streaming show.